

Client Onboarding Checklist

HERERA
SMALL BUSINESS TOOLKIT

Run this for every client, without exception. Consistency is the whole point — it is what makes a one-person business feel established.

BEFORE YOU SAY YES

- ☐ Intake form received and read in full
- ☐ Budget confirmed as workable
- ☐ Timeline checked against your current load
- ☐ Decision-maker identified by name
- ☐ Discovery call held and notes written up
- ☐ Any red flags noted and honestly weighed

WINNING THE WORK

- ☐ Proposal sent within 24 hours of the call
- ☐ Three tiers offered, middle one recommended
- ☐ Scope exclusions written down explicitly
- ☐ Follow-up sent if no reply after 3 days
- ☐ Tier confirmed in writing

LOCKING IT IN

- ☐ Contract sent with the deposit invoice
- ☐ Signed contract received and filed
- ☐ Deposit cleared in your account
- ☐ Start date confirmed to the client
- ☐ Project added to your calendar and tracker

FIRST WEEK

- ☐ Welcome email sent with next steps
- ☐ All materials and access received
- ☐ Shared folder or workspace set up
- ☐ Timeline sent with feedback windows marked
- ☐ Communication channel and hours agreed
- ☐ Revision policy restated in plain language

DURING THE PROJECT

- ☐ Halfway check-in sent unprompted
- ☐ Feedback consolidated into one round
- ☐ Out-of-scope requests logged, quoted, not absorbed
- ☐ Delivery date reconfirmed a week out

DELIVERY AND AFTER

- ☐ Final files delivered in agreed formats
- ☐ Final invoice sent the same day
- ☐ Payment received and logged in the tracker
- ☐ Testimonial requested while they are happy
- ☐ Portfolio permission confirmed
- ☐ Calendar reminder set to check in at 60 days

The two boxes people skip

The **halfway check-in** costs you one message and prevents almost every unpleasant surprise at delivery. The **testimonial request** has a short window — ask on the day they are delighted, not three months later.